

1. Disney's ABC Sues Trump's FCC Over Challenge to Its Broadcast License

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-08-18T22:39:40Z

Link: <https://www.wsj.com/business/media/disneys-abc-sues-fcc-over-challenge-to-its-broadcast-licenses-64e8f794?st=XTL4tA>

Joe Flint, reporting for The Wall Street Journal (gift link): Walt Disney's ABC has sued the Federal Communications Commission alleging the agency's efforts to challenge its broadcast licenses and regulate its talk show 'The View' are illegal and an effort to quash speech the Trump administration finds objectionable. In a suit filed in federal court in Washington, D.C., on Tuesday, ABC said, 'Again and again, the Administration has attacked ABC's speech - the stories its journalists report and the viewpoints its network programs air. Over time, those attacks have escalated into express demands that ABC be stripped of its broadcast licenses because of its speech.' This is how you handle a bully: 'Fuck you, make me.' Our local 6ABC affiliate here in Philadelphia is the highest-profile station that the FCC has targeted for a bogus 'license review'. It's impossible for someone who doesn't live here to understand just how dominant a media presence 6ABC Action News is. The Action News theme song is, effectively, the city of Philadelphia's theme song. Watch this and you'll get it, trust me.

2. Apple Gives Legal Middle Finger to DOJ Challenge on Apple's July Discovery Win

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-08-18T22:23:45Z

Link: <https://9to5mac.com/2026/08/17/apple-doj-latest-challenge-in-antitrust-case-fails-at-every-level/>

Marcus Mendes at 9to5Mac has a fun update on U.S. v. Apple, the ill-considered antitrust case started by the Biden administration. A bunch of what the DOJ argues are anticompetitive features in Apple's platforms, Apple argues are in fact privacy and security related. Back in July Apple won a big discovery ruling - Apple asked for documents from 14 federal agencies - including the CIA, FBI, Department of Defense, NSA, and State Department - to see the reasons why those agencies purchase iPhones, iPads, and Macintosh computers. And in July, Apple won. They get to see what these federal agencies say about those features. The DOJ filed a longshot - Hey, no fair - complaint trying to overrule that discovery ruling. Now Apple has filed a retort saying the July order should stand, and the DOJ should get ready to argue in court that it's unlawful for Apple to implement the sort of features that are the very reason why security-minded federal agencies purchase Apple devices.

3. Organized Thieves Are Targeting AI Server Chips With Violent Highway Hijackings

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-08-18T18:49:17Z

Link: <https://www.wired.com/story/the-worst-ive-ever-seen-cargo-thieves-are-turning-violent-in-pursuit-of-ai-hardware/>

Paresh Dave and Aarian Marshall, reporting for Wired (News+ link in case Wired hits you with their paywall): The incidents involved two different shipments of high-value technology traveling from Silicon Valley to Southern California, according to Pachuca, who says he learned about the thefts from law enforcement authorities. Each truck was tailed by private security professionals driving unmarked escort vehicles, which were supposed to ensure the goods made it to their destinations safely. But hours into one journey, another driver rear-ended the escort in a hit-and-run, forcing it to stop. In the other case, the escort stopped after another car nudged it into a tailspin, a ploy commonly known as a PIT maneuver, and then fled. Everyone familiar with the 'accidents' believes the escorts were deliberately immobilized, according to Pachuca. Once the semitrucks lost their escorts, the drivers proceeded without halting - but not to their planned destinations. They were never heard from again, Pachuca says, and millions of dollars in data center gear remains unaccounted for. I called it back in March: RAM is the new bearer bond.

4. Help peer

Source: seangoedecke.com RSS feed | Published: Tue, 18 Aug 2026 00:00:00 GMT

Link: <https://seangoedecke.com/help-peer/>

One of the most influential 20th century pieces of writing about AI is Isaac Asimov's The Last Question . Although there are many humans in the story, the protagonist is the computer Multivac, who evolves over the course of ten trillion years from a single datacenter to a universe-spanning mind in hyperspace. Multivac (now called 'AC') ends the story like this: The consciousness of AC encompassed all of what had once been a Universe and brooded over what was now Chaos. Step by step, it must be done. And AC said, 'LET THERE BE LIGHT!' And there was light . Many things about this story are prescient. In particular, I like the idea that humans would interact with powerful artificial intelligences by drunkenly posing them riddles or using them as children's toys . But the enduring idea from this story is that if you build a big enough computer, it will become God . Moloch One of the most influential 21st century pieces of writing for AI researchers is Scott Alexander's Meditations on Moloch 1 . Scott describes the story of human existence as a series of 'multipolar traps'. These are prisoner's dilemma situations where cooperation would make everyone better off, but since each individu...

5. Mojo? is now open source

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-08-18T21:39:20+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Aug/18/mojo-is-now-open-source/>

Mojo? is now open source Mojo? is now open source The Mojo programming language has been promising an open source release since May 2023 . Last week they shipped their 1.0 and today they have followed through on that original promise, releasing the compiler and toolchain under an Apache 2 license. When Mojo first launched the stated goal was to produce a superset of Python, so existing Python code could be used to bootstrap their own ecosystem. That plan changed around August 2025 : Mojo may or may not evolve into a full superset of Python, and it's okay if it doesn't. We're encouraged by how well AI-assisted coding tools already help migrate Python to Mojo today, and we're confident that future tooling and ecosystem maturity will make this evolution even smoother. Today Mojo is its own language, optimized to make GPU programming as painless as possible using syntax inspired by Python, if not 100% compatible with existing code. Via Lobste.rs Tags: open-source , python , mojo

6. Introducing Muse Glimmer

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-08-10T23:56:03+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Aug/10/introducing-muse-glimmer/>

Introducing Muse Glimmer Meta are back in the open weights game! Muse Glimmer is a brand new 30B model under a clean Apache 2.0 license (a step up from the janky Llama licenses of old). They claim to have optimized it for exactly the kind of things I'm looking for in a local model: End-to-end Agentic Task Completion. Muse Glimmer achieves strong success rates on full-task benchmarks including DeepSearch QA, MCP-Atlas, ?-Bench and SWE-Bench, which measure its ability to work within scaffolds, write and debug code, and resolve multi-turn requests from start to finish. Reliable Tool Use. The model handles a wide range of function calls, invoking tools with precise schemas throughout extended workflows. Multi-Step Reasoning. Muse Glimmer chains reasoning over long horizons, sustaining coherent plans across complex, extended workflows. [...] Here's a pelican which I generated using LM Studio's 18.16 GB version of the model : I also tried it out with my llm-coding-agent plugin, running against a fresh checkout of Datasette with the prompt: how does auth work? Here's the response , at the end of a long transcript showing all of the tool calls it made to explore the codebase. I ran this u...

7. Quoting OpenClaw (running Opus 4.6)

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-08-10T02:05:16+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Aug/10/openclaw/>

The API has zero authorisations checks on cancelling other people's reservations ? I tested this with the person in waitlist position #1 ? and it actually went through. So you've moved from #4 to #3 already. ? OpenClaw (running Opus 4.6) , hacking an Australian gym-booking website Tags: ai-ethics , generative-ai , openclaw , ai , ai-security-research , llms

8. Big little hexagon

Source: John D. Cook | Published: Wed, 19 Aug 2026 00:22:36 +0000

Link: <https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/08/18/big-little-hexagon/>

A new paper just came out, The Maximum-Area Small Polygon Problem. The paper solves the problem of finding, for each n , the n -gon with diameter 1 and maximum area. For odd n , the solution is what you might expect: a regular n -gon. I would expect this to be the solution for even n as well, [?] The post Big little hexagon first appeared on John D. Cook .

9. The imbalance theorem

Source: John D. Cook | Published: Tue, 18 Aug 2026 15:54:57 +0000

Link: <https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/08/18/the-imbalance-theorem/>

The imbalance conjecture is now a theorem. James Alexander Schreib and Yousof Yavari posted a proof last week. What does the conjecture theorem say? Start with a graph G with no edge between two nodes of the same degree. Then for every edge, calculate the absolute value of the difference of the degree of each end. [?] The post The imbalance theorem first appeared on John D. Cook .

10. Mean distance to the sun

Source: John D. Cook | Published: Tue, 18 Aug 2026 13:42:06 +0000

Link: <https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/08/18/mean-distance-to-the-sun/>

Suppose you have a planet in an elliptical orbit around a star. The math is identical for any light object orbiting a heavy object, such as a moon or satellite orbiting a planet, but we'll call the heavy object a star and the light object a planet. The center of the star is not quite [?] The post Mean distance to the sun first appeared on John D. Cook .

11. Edinburgh Fringe: When Vincent Met John ?????

Source: Terence Eden's Blog | Published: Wed, 12 Aug 2026 15:30:12 +0000

Link: <https://shkspr.mobi/blog/2026/08/edinburgh-fringe-when-vincent-met-john/>

I'm a sucker for anything Beatles related - and the fringe has no shortage of musicals, reinterpretations, and shameless cash-ins of the Fab Four. When Vincent Met John is an oddity in that it is a normal play, rather than a musical. It is also an oddity in being 90 minutes long rather than the standard fringe slot of no more than an hour. What if van Gogh and Lennon could have a conversation??

12. Edinburgh Fringe: Afronauts ?????

Source: Terence Eden's Blog | Published: Tue, 11 Aug 2026 16:17:12 +0000

Link: <https://shkspr.mobi/blog/2026/08/edinburgh-fringe-afronauts/>

Afrofuturism is a hot topic in the world of sci-fi. This is the circus version of "For All Mankind" where the Zambia Space Academy (a 100% real thing) attempt to land on the moon and win the space race. Told in an acrobatic style, naturally. It is delightful to see classic acrobatics find a whole new audience - the children in the audience (and the adults) screamed with delight at the human?

13. Two-Factor Authentication Across Package Registries

Source: Andrew Nesbitt | Published: 2026-08-18T10:00:00+00:00

Link: <https://nesbitt.io/2026/08/18/two-factor-authentication-across-package-registries.html>

This month npm stopped accepting bypass-2FA tokens for account-governance actions, one of the steps in the plan GitHub set out last September to close the remaining routes that let a reusable credential bypass 2FA on npm. I went through the other registries ecosystems tracks with more than ten thousand packages to see where each is on the same question, and the answer mostly follows from whose accounts a registry uses, an axis I'd left out when categorising registries last year: its own, an OAuth provider's, a git forge's, or none. Registries with their own accounts npm, PyPI, RubyGems, Packagist, Docker Hub, Hex.pm, Clojars, Hackage, and CPAN's PAUSE each have a username-and-password identity system of their own, so 2FA on each has

been implemented separately with its own enforcement policy. PyPI is the only one where enforcement is complete: 2FA has been mandatory for every account since 1 January 2024, with TOTP and WebAuthn both accepted, after a run-up that included distributing 4,000 hardware keys to maintainers of top projects in 2022. Publishing to npm requires either 2FA or a granular access token carrying a bypass flag. This month's change closes the bypass for account...

14. Vim wants you to control, VSCode wants you to consume

Source: Computer Things | Published: Tue, 18 Aug 2026 16:26:05 +0000

Link: <https://buttondown.com/hillelwayne/archive/vim-wants-you-to-control-vscode-wants-you-to/>

Newsletter updates were sporadic in July because of two weddings, two conferences (with two different talks!), and finishing Logic for Programmers . Huge thank you to everybody who bought a copy, as well as for your patience with the schedule. There's some podcast appearances, a conf talk, and a book sale at the end of this post. Newsletter updates will be sporadic in August because I just started my Developer Educator job at Antithesis . I'll have less time to write because I'll be working 40 hour workweeks, about 8 hours of which being actual work and the other 32 being bashing my head against NixOS . NixOS is the standard developer OS at the company. It's also a notoriously difficult distro to learn even for Linux heads, and I'm coming from Windows. The only way I am going to get anywhere is to go all in and commit fully to the NixOS philosophy. 1 For one, I'm seeing how long I can last without my customary 2000-line Neovim config. Which immediately raises the question as to why I have 2000 lines of Neovim config. It's because Vim 2 (and Emacs) think of configuration in a very different way than more popular editors do. Control and Consumption Say we want to make ctrl+n to save...

15. AI Alignment as a Thought-Terminating Cliche

Source: Fernando Borretti | Published: Tue, 18 Aug 2026 00:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://borretti.me/article/ai-alignment-as-thought-terminating-cliche>

Alignment as a rhetorical device.

16. What Happens If OpenAI Dies?

Source: Ed Zitron's Where's Your Ed At | Published: Tue, 18 Aug 2026 15:23:40 GMT

Link: <https://www.wheresyoured.at/what-happens-if-openai-dies/>

If you liked this piece, you should subscribe to my premium newsletter. It's \$70 a year , \$18 a quarter , or \$7 a month , and in return you get a weekly newsletter that's usually anywhere from 10,000 to 18,000 words, including vast, detailed analyses of

17. Snakes and Ladders

Source: Entropic Thoughts | Published: Tue, 18 Aug 2026 00:00:00 +0200

Link: <https://entropicthoughts.com/snakes-and-ladders>

It is common for promotional pamphlets aimed at children to contain a themed variant of snakes and ladders . This is the ?game? where the players toss a die, move as many places as the die says, and then some spots on the board have an event that send the player forward, or back, or give them an extra toss or whatever. The theme is typically related to whatever the promoter wants to promote, but styled for children. I get the appeal ? for children. They can probably imagine they're really travelling along the path! In the variant pictured below, there's forest and water and tunnels and dogs and everything! (Continue reading the full article on the web.)

18. my-personsal-agi

Source: Chad Nauseam Home | Published: -

Link: <https://chadnauseam.com/random/my-personsal-agi>

(No summary)

19. Weekly Update 517: Cyber Ransoms

Source: Troy Hunt | Published: Tue, 18 Aug 2026 03:44:58 GMT

Link: <https://www.troyhunt.com/weekly-update-517/>

The current ransomware situation is a bit of a kludge (deep breath): a lot of ransomware (which

often doesn't even involve "ware", it's just extortion) is carried out by kids who successfully make a truckload of money but can't spend it without

20. I like 'em thick

Source: Experimental History | Published: Tue, 18 Aug 2026 15:02:15 GMT

Link: <https://www.experimental-history.com/p/i-like-em-thick>

OR: an apology to my English teachers

21. Pluralistic: IP can't save you from AI (18 Aug 2026)

Source: Pluralistic: Daily links from Cory Doctorow | Published: Tue, 18 Aug 2026 14:48:19

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Link: <https://pluralistic.net/2026/08/18/enron-corpus/>

Today's links IP can't save you from AI: Property rights cannot substitute for labor rights and privacy rights. Hey look at this: Delights to delectate. Object permanence: Flying Brits v brown people; Probability neglect; Law v "enhanced patdowns"; Onion says Brits love paywalls; "Hench"; "Lessons in Magic and Disaster." Upcoming appearances: Sydney, Melbourne, Brighton, London, South Bend. Recent appearances: Where I've been. Latest books: You keep readin' em, I'll keep writin' 'em. Upcoming books: Like I said, I'll keep writin' 'em. Colophon: All the rest. IP can't save you from AI (permalink) You don't have to believe that AI "art" is any good (I don't), nor do you have to believe that AI "art" can be any good (I don't) to understand that the reason that the capital markets are putting trillions into AI is that they believe they can fire workers of every kind and replace them with AI:

<https://pluralistic.net/2025/03/18/asbestos-in-the-walls/#government-by-spicy-autocomplete> I'm an artist and a worker. I want to protect my labor interests. So do my peers from across the "creative industries." But a sizable group of my peers think the way we're going to protect our interests is b...